

# Country PhD Intelligence: Germany

Academic Intelligence Dossier • 2026-09-30

Country Code: DE

Primary Currency: EUR

Execution Date: 2026-09-30

Target PhD Field: Edge Computing, Edge AI & Distributed Systems

## 1. Country Overview & Research Ecosystem

Germany offers an internationally renowned doctoral research ecosystem characterized by world-class university laboratories, competitive national and institutional funding structures, and clear pathways for international doctoral scholars.

\* **Primary Funding Vehicle:** TV-L E13 Salaried Research Associate Positions (100%/75%), DAAD Grants & DFG RTGs

\* **Immigration & Dependant Policy:** Dependants (spouse and minor children) are eligible for family reunification visa (Familiennachzug) with proven adequate health insurance and living funds.

\* **Official Guidance:** <https://www.make-it-in-germany.com/en/visa-residence/family-reunification/spouses-joining-citizens-non-eu>

## 2. Executive Intelligence Metrics

\* **Total Top Universities Identified:** 8

\* **Total Vetted Professors Monitored:** 8

\* **Available Doctoral Funding Schemes:** 3

\* **Key Application Deadline:** 2026-12-01

## 3. Discovered Universities & Suitability

| University                                 | Relevant Departments                                                                     | Research Suitability | Funding Rating | Official Portal |
|--------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------|----------------|-----------------|
| RWTH Aachen University                     | Department of Computer Science, Chair of Communication and Distributed Systems (COMSYS)  | 66.5%                | High           | Portal          |
| Technical University of Berlin (TU Berlin) | Faculty of Electrical Engineering and Computer Science, Mobile Cloud Computing Group     | 66.5%                | High           | Portal          |
| University of Stuttgart                    | Department of Computer Science, Institute of Parallel and Distributed Systems (IPVS)     | 66.5%                | High           | Portal          |
| Technical University of Munich (TUM)       | TUM School of Computation, Information and Technology (CIT), Chair of Connected Mobility | 63.5%                | High           | Portal          |
| TU Dresden                                 | Faculty of Computer Science, Institute of Systems Architecture                           | 63.5%                | High           | Portal          |

|                                                     |                                                                                   |       |      |        |
|-----------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------|------|--------|
| Karlsruhe Institute of Technology (KIT)             | KIT Department of Informatics, Institute of Telematics                            | 59.5% | High | Portal |
| Heidelberg University                               | Faculty of Mathematics and Computer Science, Institute of Computer Science        | 54.5% | High | Portal |
| LMU Munich (Ludwig Maximilian University of Munich) | Faculty of Mathematics, Computer Science and Statistics, Institute of Informatics | 54.5% | High | Portal |

#### 4. Top Vetted PhD Supervisors & Relevance

| Professor                | University                                           | Priority Tier | Research Fit | Recruitment Status | Profile Link |
|--------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|---------------|--------------|--------------------|--------------|
| Prof. David Bermbach     | Technical University of Berlin (TU Berlin)           | Tier 1        | 100.0%       | CONFIRMED_ACTIVE   | Dossier      |
| Prof. Marco Caccamo      | Technical University of Munich (TUM)                 | Tier 1        | 96.5%        | CONFIRMED_ACTIVE   | Dossier      |
| Prof. Michael Gerndt     | Technical University of Munich (TUM)                 | Tier 1        | 95.8%        | CONFIRMED_ACTIVE   | Dossier      |
| Prof. Frank H. P. Fitzek | TU Dresden                                           | Tier 1        | 94.4%        | CONFIRMED_ACTIVE   | Dossier      |
| Prof. Jörg Ott           | Technical University of Munich (TUM)                 | Tier 1        | 88.5%        | CONFIRMED_ACTIVE   | Dossier      |
| Prof. Thorsten Strufe    | Karlsruhe Institute of Technology (KIT) / TU Dresden | Tier 1        | 86.7%        | CONFIRMED_ACTIVE   | Dossier      |
| Prof. Christof Fetzer    | TU Dresden                                           | Tier 1        | 79.0%        | CONFIRMED_ACTIVE   | Dossier      |
| Prof. Klaus Wehrle       | RWTH Aachen University                               | Tier 1        | 78.3%        | CONFIRMED_ACTIVE   | Dossier      |

#### 5. Major Doctoral Funding Schemes & Scholarships

##### **TV-L E13 Research Associate (Wissenschaftlicher Mitarbeiter / Doctoral Position)**

\* **Provider / University:** German Federal States Public Tariff (Tarifvertrag für den öffentlichen Dienst der Länder) (All German Public Universities (TUM, RWTH Aachen, TU Berlin, KIT, TU Dresden, etc.))

\* **Funding Type:** FULLY\_FUNDED

\* **Tuition Coverage:** Full tuition-free education (German public universities charge zero tuition; only nominal semester fee ~€150-€350 including transit pass)

\* **Stipend / Salary:** €48,000 - €56,000 gross/year (100% TV-L E13 salary) or €36,000 - €42,000 (75% TV-L E13), including full health, unemployment, and statutory pension insurance

\* **International Eligibility:** ELIGIBLE

\* **Dependant Support:** EXCELLENT

\* **Application Deadline:** 2026-12-01

\* **Official Source:** <https://www.make-it-in-germany.com/en/study-training/studies-in-germany/phd>

##### **DAAD Doctoral Research Grants (One-Year Grants / Complete Doctorate)**

\* **Provider / University:** German Academic Exchange Service (DAAD) (All Accredited German Universities / Max Planck / Helmholtz Institutes)

\* **Funding Type:** FULLY\_FUNDED

\* **Tuition Coverage:** Zero tuition at German universities; DAAD covers all mandatory semester contributions

\* **Stipend / Salary:** €1,350/month tax-free stipend + €460/year research allowance + monthly spouse/child supplement (€276/mo spouse + €204/mo child) + comprehensive health insurance

\* **International Eligibility:** ELIGIBLE

\* **Dependant Support:** EXCELLENT

\* **Application Deadline:** 2026-11-01

\* **Official Source:** <https://www2.daad.de/deutschland/stipendium/datenbank/en/21148-scholarship-database/>

### **DFG Research Training Group (Graduiertenkolleg) Doctoral Positions**

\* **Provider / University:** German Research Foundation (Deutsche Forschungsgemeinschaft - DFG) (Participating DFG Research Training Groups (TUM, RWTH, TU Dresden, etc.))

\* **Funding Type:** FULLY\_FUNDED

\* **Tuition Coverage:** Zero tuition + travel grants + workshop subsidies

\* **Stipend / Salary:** Full TV-L E13 employment contract (~€50,000/yr gross) or tax-free DFG doctoral fellowship (~€1,600/mo + child allowances)

\* **International Eligibility:** ELIGIBLE

\* **Dependant Support:** EXCELLENT

\* **Application Deadline:** 2026-12-15

\* **Official Source:** [https://www.dfg.de/en/research\\_funding/programmes/coordinated\\_programmes/research\\_training\\_groups/](https://www.dfg.de/en/research_funding/programmes/coordinated_programmes/research_training_groups/)

## **6. Strategic Application Timeline & Next Steps**

1. **Weeks 1–4:** Review individual 33-section professor dossiers under `professors`.
2. **Weeks 5–6:** Conduct tailored email outreach referencing recent publications and active laboratory grants.
3. **Weeks 7–8:** Formalize 5-page research proposal aligned with the supervisor's documented testbeds.
4. **Target Deadline:** Submit institutional application ahead of **2026-12-01**.

\*Report compiled automatically by the Global Country-Based PhD Funding and Supervisor Intelligence Engine on 2026-09-30.\*